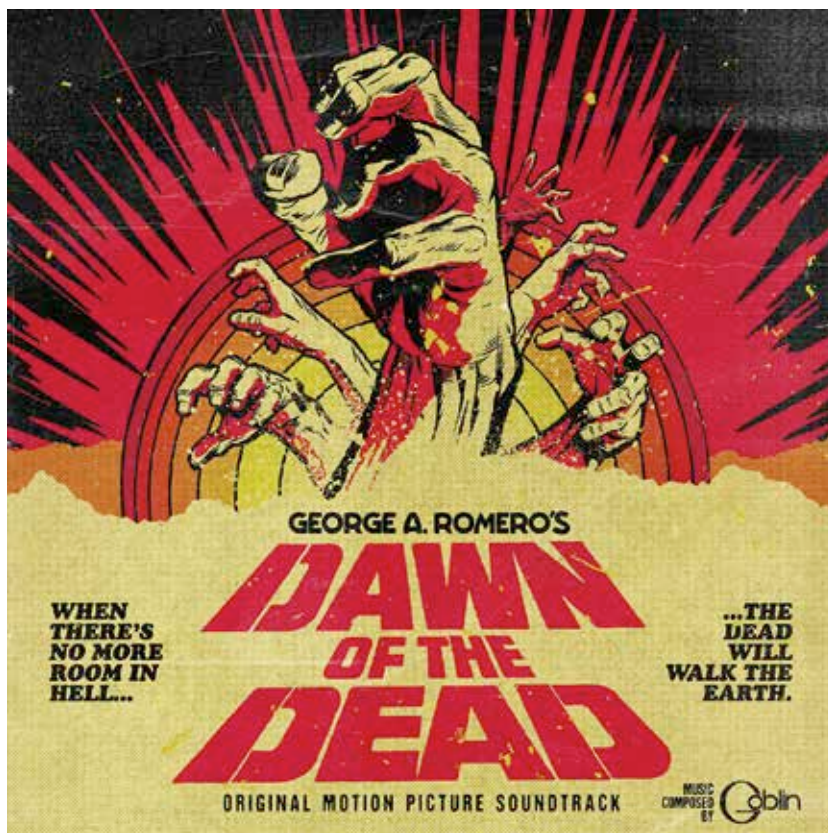




ing at the Hilton and he gave it to me because he knew I liked games. I went mainly because I wanted to eat at the Hilton for free, but once I started talking to Capcom people, really getting in-depth about the work they do, I thought it sounded pretty neat.

So I applied to both Capcom and Nintendo, and it turned out the second round of interviews for both companies was held on the same day, and I chose Capcom. It's likely for the better because I probably never had a chance with Nintendo."

Once in Capcom, Mikami was inspired by a fellow game developer, Tokuro Fujiwara, director of *Ghosts 'n Goblins*, *Commando* and a little horror title called *Sweet Home*. Mikami learnt the art of game development from Fujiwara and was even tasked with working on a modern reboot of the classic horror game. Not impressed with the feeling of dread and bleak nature of *Sweet Home*, Mikami initially refused the project, stating that he was not built to direct a scary horror game because he did not like being scared, but that exact quality was what made him perfect for the job. He understood being scared and scaring people quite well.

With this in mind, he began working on a zombie game set in a mansion. He was a fan of the Italian horror flick, *Zombi 2* and was looking at recreating the atmosphere and tension but wanted to improve on what he thought were the weakest parts of the film. George A Romero's *Dawn of the Dead* also played a massive role in the mood and setting of the game. Thus, *Resident Evil* was born.

The title proved to be a massive success and was one of the most important games for the original PlayStation. It revolutionised the industry and was one of the first games to use effective pre-rendered backgrounds and static camera angles to craft a truly frightening experience on consoles. There had not been a game like *Resident Evil* ever, and Mikami basically created a template for a lot of future horror and sci-fi titles like *Gale-rions* and the *Resident Evil* sequels.

He continued working in Capcom and ushered in *Resident Evil 2* and oversaw the development of *Resident Evil 3: Nemesis*. Mikami even directed *Dino Crisis*. The survival horror game went on to become a cult title in the eyes of many gamers and even got a sequel in *Dino Crisis 2*.

Changing The Game

Backed by an insanely impressive resume, Mikami was then tasked with